Preface to the Rails 7 Edition

Rails 1.0 was released in December 2005. In the years since, it has gone from a relatively unknown leading-edge tool to a successful and stable foundation with a large set of associated libraries that others benchmark themselves against.

The book you're about to read was there from the start, and it has evolved with Rails. It began as a full reference to a small framework when online documentation was scarce and inconsistent. It's now an introduction to the entire Rails ecosystem—one that leaves you with many pointers to more information that you can explore based on your needs and desires.

This book didn't just evolve along with Rails: Rails evolved with it. The content in this book has been developed in consultation with the Rails core team. Not only is the code you'll see in this book tested against each release of Rails, but the converse is also true: Rails itself is tested against the code in this book and won't be released until those tests pass.

So read this book with confidence that the scenarios not only work but also describe how the Rails developers themselves feel about how best to use Rails. We hope you get as much pleasure out of reading this book as we had in developing it.

This book covers Rails 7. While some of the commands you'll be using are new, the underlying development model remains the same. Even when new major features are added, such as the tight integration with JavaScipt import maps, changes are evolutionary, not revolutionary.

Rails 7 introduced an entirely new way to produce state of the art user